Revision Date:
October 01, 2026

Background:
Counties must report work participation data to the California Department of Social Services (CDSS), and the Federal Data Reporting and Analysis Bureau (FDRAB) monthly, in accordance with County Temporary Assistance to Needy Families (TANF) data reporting instructions. CDSS utilized two systems to collect work participation data: the Research and Development Enterprise Project (RADEP) and Enterprise II Lite (E2Lite). RADEP was used to collect data for the federal sample for submission to the Federal Administration for Children and Families (ACF), including the statewide Work Participation Rate (WPR). E2Lite was used to collect data for the county sample, which supplements the RADEP sample, monitors local and regional WPR performance, and calculates each county's share of any federal fiscal penalty that California may incur due to not meeting WPR requirements.

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Purpose:
The purpose of this section is to outline federal WPR policies regarding weekly participation, countable core activities, CalSAWS data requirements, and related documentation. This section was revised as the RADEP and E2Lite systems were eliminated and replaced with a streamlined data collection process that pulls directly from the California Statewide Automated Welfare System (CalSAWS) administrative data. CDSS further clarified that counties are no longer subject to a WPR penalty passthrough so there is no need to calculate a county-specific WPR via E2Lite. Updates were also made to add clarifying language and guidance regarding core WPR activities, to update the section to the current format, and for sunset review.

Policy:
There are two WPR measures with distinct requirements: the All Families Rate and the Two-Parent Families Rate. The All Families WPR is the average of the participation rates for all families, including the Two-Parent Families, for each month in the Federal Fiscal Year (FFY). The Two-Parent WPR only includes the average of the participation rates for families that meet the federal definition of Two-Parent Families for WPR – having two work-eligible individuals (WEIs) – for each month in the FFY.

Federal Requirements for All Families WPR
Fifty percent of all families receiving TANF assistance (one-parent and two-parent families combined) must meet the following conditions:

- One WEI must participate in federally allowable activities, for an average of thirty hours per week, with the following exceptions:
  - A single custodial parent with a child under six years old needs to participate in core activities for an average of twenty hours per week to meet federal All Families Rate requirements.

- A single head of household under twenty years old, without a high school diploma or equivalent, meets the federal All Families Rate requirements in a month if the individual maintains satisfactory attendance at a secondary school (or equivalent), or participates in education directly related to employment, for an average of twenty hours per week.
- At least twenty of the thirty hours must be in core activities.

Federal Requirements for Two-Parent Families WPR

Ninety percent of two-parent families with two WEIs must meet both of the following requirements:

- The WEIs must participate in federally allowable work activities for a combined average of thirty five hours per week.
- At least thirty of the thirty five weekly hours must be in core activities.

Core Activities

There are nine federal WPR activities that count for the first twenty core hours required for the All Families WPR or the thirty hour core requirement for the Two-Parent Family WPR:

- Unsubsidized employment.
- Subsidized private-sector employment.
- Subsidized public-sector employment.
- Work experience.
- On-the-job training.
- Job search/job readiness assistance.
- Community service programs.
- Vocational educational training (not to exceed the twelve-month lifetime limit for any individual).
- Providing childcare services to an individual who is participating in a community service program.

WPR Documentation

The elimination of the E2Lite system for WPR reporting did not change federal WPR documentation requirements.

Note: The WPR Instructions and Definitions guide is available in the Resources section of the CalWORKs and Welfare-To-Work SharePoint sites.

Procedure:

Processing Guides 10-002.A2, 10-002.A4, 10-002.A5

Impacts:

CalSAWS Data Requirements

Staff must continue entering data into CalSAWS in a thorough and timely manner to support CDSS in meeting federal reporting requirements.

References:

- SB 119.
- ACL No. 22-22, 25-74, 25-77.
- MPP 42-714.

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance by September 30, 2029.

Approval for Release:



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